

cft-anyons Lab Book
From category data to provably rigorous CFTs

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1 Frontmatter, North Star, and Claim Status

This is a reproducible research lab book. Its guiding goal — the *north star* — is a single, concrete construction problem:

Given a (unitary) fusion or modular tensor category $\mathcal{C}$, together with whatever additional data is needed (OPE coefficients / conformal data), construct a family of microscopic (lattice) models and their symmetry generators whose continuum limit *provably* yields a mathematically rigorous QFT/CFT that (i) realises the input category data and (ii) carries a full projective unitary representation of the symmetries.

The working belief is that this is achievable at least for *rational* CFTs, and perhaps for all QFTs. This is a programme, not a settled theory: every step toward the goal is a question, proposal, or hypothesis until a local source, a local derivation, or a reproducible run supports it.

1.1 The Two Success Criteria

A construction is only a candidate solution if it meets both, non-negotiably:

1. **Provability.** The continuum limit is established rigorously (an operator-algebraic / wavelet renormalisation limit with theorems, not a heuristic scaling argument).
2. **Fidelity.** The realised continuum content faithfully reproduces the input category data $\mathcal{C}$, and the symmetry representation is *full* and projective-unitary.

1.2 Claim Status

No claim is treated as established until it is marked *Source-local* or *Checked* and linked to a local source, derivation, test, or run artifact. The status labels are fixed in `CONVENTIONS.md`: *Question*, *Proposal*, *Source-local*, *Checked*, and *Rejected*. These labels are part of the scientific record; they separate programme-level conjecture from results.

1.3 Evidence Chain

Every substantive assertion should be traceable through:

1. a local source manifest under `references/` (the kept papers are the ground truth),
2. a convention entry in `CONVENTIONS.md`,
3. a derivation, script, test, or run bundle when computation is involved,
4. an index row in `INDEX.md`, and
5. a report shard in this lab book.

Missing links are allowed during exploration only when they are explicit.

2 Programme Map

This shard is a map of questions, not a list of results. The north star (§1 / CA-00) factors into a pipeline of stages; each stage is an open problem with its own conventions, sources, and checkable invariants.

2.1 The Pipeline

$$\underbrace{\mathcal{C} \text{ (+ OPE/conformal data)}}_{\text{input}} \longrightarrow \underbrace{\text{microscopic models}}_{\text{lattice Hilbert space + Hamiltonian}} \longrightarrow \underbrace{\text{lattice symmetry generators}}_{\text{e.g. Koo-Saleur } L_n} \longrightarrow \underbrace{\text{provable con}}_{\text{OAR /}}$$

2.2 Stage 1 — Category Input

- Which categories are in initial scope: multiplicity-free unitary fusion categories (Fibonacci, Ising/TL), then modular tensor categories?
- What auxiliary data beyond $\mathcal{C}$ is genuinely required (OPE coefficients, central charge, conformal weights), and for which target CFTs?
- Which gauge and indexing conventions are fixed before any F/R-symbol is written (see `CONVENTIONS.md`)?

2.3 Stage 2 — Microscopic Models

- Which family realises $\mathcal{C}$ on the lattice: anyon chains, string-nets, or another construction — and how is the family indexed by scale?
- What is the lattice Hilbert space (fusion-tree basis) and the Hamiltonian, and which invariants pin them (fusion-rule consistency, pentagon, projector idempotence)?

2.4 Stage 3 — Lattice Symmetry Generators

- Which lattice operators approximate the continuum symmetry generators (Koo-Saleur lattice Virasoro L_n , $\bar{L}_n$, and kin)?
- What convergence statement is the target, and what is checkable at finite size (commutator algebra, central charge extraction)?

2.5 Stage 4 — Provable Continuum Limit

- Which rigorous renormalisation framework carries the limit (operator- algebraic renormalisation, wavelet / multi-scale entanglement)?
- What must be proved: existence of the limit, the limiting Hilbert space, and convergence of the symmetry generators to a projective unitary representation?

2.6 Stage 5 — Rigorous (C)FT Target

- What is the target object: a conformal net, a vertex operator algebra, or a Wightman/Osterwalder-Schrader theory?
- What is the fidelity statement: that the target’s superselection / representation category recovers $\mathcal{C}$?

2.7 First Decisions

The first technical session should not start with formulas. It should register the sources for one worked input category (Fibonacci or Ising/TL), fix the minimum conventions (F/R-symbol gauge, vacuum index, fusion-tree ordering), and identify the smallest invariant that can be checked end-to-end on one stage of the pipeline.